

Price-to-Win: Your Bid Strategy

This guide helps you build a winning federal price that covers your costs and leaves a fair profit, without guessing.

What it is. This guide helps you find the sweet spot for your federal price. You want it competitive enough to win, but high enough to make money. Winning bids isn't only about being the cheapest. We'll walk you through calculating your true costs, like G&A, fringe, and overhead, to build a solid wrap rate.

When to use it. Use these tools before you submit any federal bid, especially for opportunities over \$150,000. It's critical for understanding what the government expects to pay and how your costs compare to the market. This process usually takes a few hours, but it saves you from leaving profit on the table.

How to use it.

- Start with the "Indirect Rate Calculator" and "Indirect Rate Audit Checklist" to nail down your G&A, fringe, and overhead. These numbers are the foundation.
- Next, open the "Federal Labor Categories Matrix" and "Federal Labor Rate Benchmarks FY2026." Use these to find competitive hourly rates for your team.
- Then, use the "Price-to-Win Worksheet" to put it all together. This helps you compare your proposed price against what the government usually pays.
- Finally, review the "Sample Cost Proposal" to see how a complete, defensible cost volume looks.

Watch out for. Don't just lowball your price hoping to win. An unrealistically low bid often gets flagged or rejected because it looks unsustainable. Focus on a defensible price that shows you understand your costs and the market.

Open it in your kit: <https://app.capturepilot.com/kit/price-to-win> Next step: <https://app.capturepilot.com/kit/rfp-response> (RFP / Solicitation Response)